AI NOTES SERIES - PROMPT SHORTCUT

Compare Two Topics in a Table

Some topics are hard to learn because they look almost the same. A comparison table puts them side by side, so the similarities and the differences become clear at a glance - and revision becomes much faster.

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Copy-paste prompt

> Compare [Topic A] and [Topic B] in a clear table. Use these rows: definition, where it happens / when it is used, main steps or parts, inputs and outputs (if any), one example, and one common mistake students make. Keep the language simple for a Class [your class] student. After the table, write one line that summarises the main difference in a way I can remember.

Step 1 - Copy the prompt above.

Step 2 - Replace [Topic A], [Topic B] and [your class] with your own topics and class.

Step 3 - Paste it into ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini, Muse or any AI chat, then check the table against your textbook.

Worked example: Photosynthesis vs Respiration

Here is what a good answer looks like with two science topics every student meets.

Point	Photosynthesis	Respiration
Definition	Plants make their own food (glucose) using sunlight, water and carbon dioxide.	Living cells break down glucose to release energy for life activities.
Where it happens	In chloroplasts, mainly in green leaves.	In mitochondria, in almost all living cells.
Inputs	Carbon dioxide + water + sunlight energy.	Glucose + oxygen.
Outputs	Glucose + oxygen.	Carbon dioxide + water + energy (ATP).
When	Only in daylight, when light is available.	All the time, day and night.
Example	A mango tree making food in its leaves on a sunny day.	Your muscles releasing energy while you run.
Common mistake	Thinking plants only photosynthesise and never respire - plants do both.	Thinking respiration means only breathing - breathing brings in the oxygen, respiration uses it in cells.

One line to remember: Photosynthesis stores energy in food; respiration releases that energy - they are opposite processes.

Make the table work harder

Ask for a similarity row. Differences are only half the lesson. Add this line to the prompt: *"Add one row for what both topics have in common."* Exams often ask for similarities too.

Turn it into revision questions. After the table, ask: *"Hide the second column and turn each row into a question I can test myself with."* Covering one side and recalling it is one of the strongest study methods.

Compare more than science. The same prompt works for two historical events, two characters in a story, two grammar rules, two computer programs, or two countries in geography. Only the rows change - the method stays the same.

Shorten it for your notebook. Ask: *"Now shrink this table to the five most important rows for a one-page revision note."* A short table you actually re-read beats a long one you never open again.

Tips for a better answer

Name your class. "Class 8" in the prompt keeps the language at your level. Without it, the AI may write words that are too hard or too simple.

Give the topics exactly as your book names them. If your textbook uses a slightly different name, use the book's name, so the table matches what your teacher will ask in the exam.

Check one row yourself. Pick any row and find it in your textbook. If that row is correct, the rest is usually reliable - and checking teaches you the topic while you verify it.

> **Honest use:** Use AI to understand, not to copy. Read the table, close it, and write the comparison in your own words. Check every fact against your textbook or teacher, because AI can make mistakes. Never submit AI writing as your own work.

Try it today

Choose two topics you often mix up - arteries and veins, acids and bases, the past tense and the present perfect tense - and run the prompt once. Copy the finished table into your notebook by hand. Writing it yourself is what moves it into your memory.